

Portfolio Development Class Syllabus

Digital Art

Submitting your work for review

Excel

- For organizational purposes work progress will be reviewed with excel, students don't have to make an excel but excel still is industry standard for many animation projects

1. Make a folder of your work

As well please submit your work in a folder with your name on it and include folders

an

bg

cd

fg

an - for all animation work name the files an01.mp4 an02.mp4 an03.mp4 or an01.jpg an02.jpg

bg - for all background art work name the files bg01.jpg bg02.jpg bg03.jpg and so on

cd - for all character design work name the files cd01.jpg cd02.jpg cd03.jpg and so on

fg - for all figure drawing work and sketchbook name the files fg01.jpg fg02.jpg fg03.jpg and so on

sb - for all storyboard work name the files sb01.jpg sb02.jpg sb03.jpg or in pdf

Make sure the file is .jpg

2. For Reviewing work

(a) MPV.io

For reviewing work MPV.io will be used, you don't need to download this program but I would recommend it for watching video and doing playback

Alternative: If you only have an iPad Dropbox also works or the default program on iPad, mpv.io is good for playback because you can go frame by frame with keyboards

- Dropbox

How to upload to Dropbox

1. Folder link is sent to you
2. go to your folder
3. import blender file
4. I get your blender file
5. I make notes on your folder
6. Updated folder is posted in the folder
7. You work more on the file

- Open Broadcaster Software

How to use Open Broadcaster to share your screen on computer

1. Download Open Broadcaster Software
2. Share your desktop
3. Share
4. Go to Zoom and share desktop through integrated Webcam

- Install Blender

Download Blender 4.32 <https://www.blender.org/download/releases/4-3/> <https://www.blender.org/download/demo-files/>

- there's also 3.6

TODO - specific version because we need to run the same version

TODO - How to update keyboard shortcuts

Animation Supplies

Traditional (meaning non-digital)

1. Animation Paper

For traditional animation Lightfoot is the main supplier of quality animation paper the paper comes in different qualities

<https://www.lightfootltd.com/catalog/animation-paper/12f-paper>

but you could just get hole punched paper

(a) About the paper

- 12 field is in reference to the size of the paper this is a good standard size of paper
- 17lb is fine paper it's basically the quality of printer paper but more transparent
- 20 lb is good better than printer paper
- Ingram paper is almost too good it's kind of like vellum and is significantly pricier
- Animation bond paper is even better but it's not 100% necessary unless you're doing very precise animation
where you really need to erase.

(b) Plastic Peg Bar

the plastic peg bar is used to keep paper together using the wholes

<https://www.lightfootltd.com/content/acme-pegbar-plastic>

(c) Documenting your animation

if you were to animate with paper you would have to use a peg bar and hole punched paper along with a light table and then shoot your animation with whats called a downshooter or document camera or your phone

<https://www.animationexploration.org/2020/03/15/diy-downshooter/>

(d) * a word on traditional animation

The main thing to consider in traditional is that you need to shoot your animation, each frame you have to take a photo of using a camera at the exact same spot and then you have to sequence them all together and composite them as a video file, so that will take around 10 minutes to an hour based on the complexity each time.

This doesn't mean that you have to shoot it every time to look at it you can flip it like a flipbook that's what animators in the past would do instead of shooting it every time, but you do have to film it in a well lit space and then time it out.

Digital

Tools that can be used for digital animation

1. Procreate -

Procreate can be used

just make sure that you are animating on 24 frames per second in procreate and then setting the duration of each individual frame

2. Clip Studio Paint

- clip studio paint is a great software as it also allows for painting and illustration making and has a timeline for animation along with actions

(a) Using Clip Studio Paint for Animation

This is a good breakdown on how to use Clip Studio Paint for Animation

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3s88IcD2Q-8>

3. TVPAINT

<https://tvpaint.com/en/products/prices> For classes you can use whichever program that you are comfortable with but for giving notes- the notes that I give will be done with TVPaint. You do not need TVPaint for the class though. I would recommend getting it at some point especially if you are accepted to CalArts because to my knowledge they do make you get a copy of it.

4. Blender

- Blender has 2D and CG capabilities but it's kind of hard to use or get the hang of if you have any free time you might want to take a look at the program. It is only operational on computers though and does not have IPAD support

5. Photoshop

Photoshop might as well be used for character design notes or background design notes

Hotkeys (This is in progress but these are the keyboard shortcuts that I would recommend)

try these keyboard shortcuts

t - move backward - t

- instead of using the arrow keys have your keybrushes reachable in on the left side and the middle. This makes it easier to reach

y - move forward - y

- y is to the left

q - move up a layer

- reachable by pinkie finger so you can quickly use your pointer finger to move left and right and then use your pointer finger to move left and right

a - move down a layer

u - undo - u

- if you're undoing a lot switching back and forth between t and y u is easier

i - increment (insert new frame) i

- for a new drawing or keyframe hit i, this is s in blender so we will switch the over

z - z - change brush size

e - e - erase

r - r - brush

- B is usually the default but if you have t and y to switch between frames you can have r as your brush and e as your eraser it's a lot easier

w -

s

d

f

c

b

q - q - move up layer

a - a - move down layer

x -

c

v

b

n

- 1

- 2

- 3

- 4

- 5

- 6

- !

- @

- #

- \$

- %

- ^

- space

f1

f2
f3
f4
f6
f7
ctrl q
ctrl w
ctrl e
ctrl r
ctrl f
ctrl d
ctrl s
ctrl a
ctrl z
ctrl x
ctrl c
ctrl v
ctrl b
shift q -
shift a -
shift z -
shift w -
shift s -
shift x -
shift e -
shift d -
shift c -
shift r -
shift f -
shift v -
shift t -
shift g -
shift b -
- m
- l
- k
- j
- h

- g
- p
- ' -

Class Schedule

First Class

1. Introduction

Prerequisites:

Animation Software:

Procreate (\$): It's a little clunky to animate, not the best Layer Management

Procreate Dreams: Also a little clunky to animate in, good for tweening, kind of a bit complicated.

Rough Animator (5) : *For animation I WOULD VERY MUCH RECOMMEND using this it's sony5* and is a lot easier to use for animation than procreate, especially because it has easy layers. You could almost do your animation in here, figure it out and then import it into procreate if you like the brush engine more in procreate.

Blender (Free): Computer Only - great for animating 2D and CG. Vector based.

TVPaint (300-500\$ One time License Fee forever): Calarts and Gobelins and most personal or independent projects are done with TVPaint, it is french though and will take a few weeks to arrive. I wouldn't right away recommend it, but it's good to keep in mind for the future and to know about for students. Many Animation Studios in Japan use TVPaint.

Toonboom Harmony (20+\$ Month): This is another program I'm not recommending right away but this is the industry standard for most American shows

Dropbox Account → If you're unable to have a dropbox account please let me know but it saves time and maximizes efficiency :-)

Dropbox offers cloud syncing and sharing, so if student posts work their it will already sync to my computer

-10 minutes to communicate what your project is

Overview of objectives and goals of class

2. - Things to think about before class and that we will cover:

- where do you want to focus your portfolio?
- what are the objectives?
- What is required for your project:

Competition:

High School Competition:

Summer Camp Art Application:

College Application: -<https://calarts.edu/apply/bfa-character-animation#application>

- observational artwork
- life drawings of human models
- observational drawings from real life

= other creative work

- sequential image storytelling
 - digital creative work
 - other work nondigital
- artist statement
- video introduction
- letters of recommendation
- sketchbook video

Animation terms used in class:

Drawing - A drawing in animation is the singular drawing

Frame - the frame is the number that the drawing is on so Drawing 7 is on frame 29 and should be moved to frame 45

Exposure - the exposure is how long a drawing is held for and also the count number that the drawing is to be filmed on, this comes from exposure sheet when animators would animate and hand their work to be filmed they would hand an exposure sheet explaining how long each drawing was to be held and so on

Dailies - is the name for looking through your work for review. we will have dailies to look at your work and adjust and give note. Animation is a lot of revision in the early stages, it's good to lay the foundation first before building on top so that the animation doesn't collapse when being built :-)

Arcs - arcs are the natural curved paths that masses move in

Timing - the time you take in between each drawing

Pricing

1hr class

for a 1 hour class that is 75\$ / per class meaning that we are only meeting for 1 hour that day (75/hr)

1hr and 30 minutes

for a 1 hour and thirty minute class the cost is 97.50\$ (65/hr) /per class

2 hour class

for a 2 hour class that is 120.00 (60/hr) /per class

Where classes will be held -

All classes will be held over Zoom

Class Notes are on Discord

Files are uploaded to Dropbox

CSSSA Application

Links

Application Site

Upload a video of an animation you have created that demonstrates your understanding of motion.

Please DO NOT send rotoscoped work because it won't be considered.

Your video should not exceed 2 minutes.

Class Notes

- class notes will be given in a pdf format

Class 1

DEADLINE: <2025-02-28 Fri> SCHEDULED: <2025-02-05 Wed>

This is the usual format

Portfolio Project Examples

CSSSA Portfolio Task Description:

Upload a video of an animation you have created that demonstrates your understanding of motion.

Please DO NOT send rotoscoped work because it won't be considered.

Your video should not exceed 2 minutes.